

Job Posting Analysis Worksheet

(AI Use: Level 2 - AI-Assisted Brainstorming is allowed)

Think of the job posting as a map that guides you on how to present yourself as the ideal candidate. When you understand the details—like the values and goals of the company, the purpose and responsibilities of the role, and the qualifications they seek—you can tailor your application (your resume and cover letter) to highlight how your background aligns with their needs. This detailed approach also means you'll be better prepared for interviews because you'll already have examples that prove you're right for the job. Complete this worksheet for each job that interests you. Be genuine and thorough in evaluating yourself.

Job Title:	
Company Name:	
URL to job posting:	

Step 1: Understand the Company Profile.

Note keywords and phrases about the company's products, values, mission, and culture in the left column. In the right column, consider how the company's features appeal to you - like if you've used their products or share similar values and goals.

Company Profile	Explain how your professional values and career interests align with the company's
McDonald's embraces innovation to improve operational efficiency and product quality.	I'm really drawn to McDonald's commitment to innovation because I have "realistic" career interests which means I love solving problems and finding better ways to do things. In the future, I want to be part of a team where I can contribute to continuous improvement, especially in how things are done behind the scenes.

Step 2: Understand the Job Duties.

Note keywords about the job's main goal, duties and the tasks involved in the left column. In the right column, consider which tasks you've done before (examples can be from work, volunteer roles, school projects, extra-curricular activities, etc.)

Job Duties	Explain where and when you've completed similar tasks
Ensure that all food safety protocols and quality standards are consistently followed at all locations by conducting regular audits and inspections.	- While working as a cashier at a CVS, I was trained in food safety, like checking expiration dates and ensuring the cleanliness of food areas. Though not in QA, it taught me how to stay detail-oriented and follow safety protocols. - In a food science project at during my undergrad at Northeastern University, I helped create a quality assurance plan for a restaurant, focusing on food safety and inspections. This project gave me hands-on experience with QA processes

Step 3: Understand the Requirements/Qualifications.

Note keywords about the required education/training, experience, and skills in the left column. In the right column, explain what your qualification is, and when and where you obtained it.

Education (Summarize the required education/training for the job)	Summarize your relevant education/training
Co-op student in a relevant field (Food Science, Quality Assurance, Business Administration)	I'm currently in the co-op program at Northeastern University, majoring in Project Management. I also hold a Bachelor's degree in Food Science from Simon University, where I gained a solid understanding of food safety protocols and quality control systems.
Experience (Summarize the required experience for the job)	Summarize your relevant experience (work, volunteer, school, extra-curriculars)
Experience in a QA or food safety role preferred.	I earned my Bachelor's in Food Science, where I gained knowledge in food safety and quality control. I also work at a grocery store, where I'm responsible for following company policies and procedures related to proper food handling to ensure product safety.
Professional Skills (Select the 2 most critical hard skills required for the job)	Explain where and when you developed or displayed the required skills
Knowledge of food safety regulations and industry standards	During my undergrad, I took a Food Safety & Quality Assurance course where I learned about food safety regulations like HACCP and FDA guidelines. I studied how these standards ensure food safety by identifying and controlling hazards at every stage of production, from sourcing to packaging. I also learned how to create sanitation plans, conduct risk assessments, and monitor critical control points to prevent contamination.
Power Skills (Select the 2 most critical soft skills required for the job)	Explain where and when you developed or displayed the required skills
Strong attention to detail skills	At the grocery store, I'm responsible for checking product labels, verifying expiration dates, and ensuring correct product placement. This requires me to be very meticulous and double-check everything to avoid errors.

Note: It's always a good idea to categorize qualifications into broader themes—like grouping all technological skills together. Assess your own qualifications in relation to these groupings. It's okay if you do not meet every requirement, strive to meet at least 75% of them. More importantly, you'll have to illustrate that you have these qualifications in your resume, cover letter and eventually interviews by emphasizing how, where and when you've developed these qualifications with specific examples.